Commas & Apostrophes (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Commas in lists: Punctuate this list correctly: 'The shop sold apples oranges pears and plums.'

Answer: 'The shop sold apples, oranges, pears and plums.' — commas separate each item except before the final 'and'.

Apostrophes for contraction: What does the apostrophe show in 'don't'?

Answer: It shows a letter has been missed out — 'don't' is short for 'do not', and the apostrophe sits where the 'o' of 'not' is removed.

Apostrophes for possession: Write the possessive form for 'the bag belonging to the girl' and for 'the toys belonging to the two boys'.

Answer: 'the girl's bag' (one girl, apostrophe before s); 'the boys' toys' (more than one boy, apostrophe after the plural s).

Purple — Getting Started (15 questions)

1. Add commas to this list: 'We packed shorts shirts socks and sandals.'
2. Rewrite using an apostrophe for the missing letters: 'I will not go without my coat.' (shorten 'will not')
3. Which sentence uses commas correctly in a list? A) The bowl had apples, pears, and, grapes. B) The bowl had apples pears and grapes. C) The bowl had apples, pears and grapes. D) The bowl, had apples pears and grapes. E) The bowl had, apples, pears and grapes.
4. Write the possessive form: the bike belonging to Tom.
5. Underline the apostrophe's job (contraction or possession) in: 'The cat's whiskers twitched.'
6. Underline the apostrophe's job (contraction or possession) in: 'I can't find my shoes.'
7. Select ALL that apply. Which of these words correctly use an apostrophe for a contraction? A) don't B) girls' C) can't D) it's E) dogs
8. Add a comma to separate the direct address in: 'Please pass the salt Grandad.'
9. Which sentence correctly shows possession for one dog? A) The dogs bone was buried. B) The dog's bone was buried. C) The dogs' bone was buried. D) The dog,s bone was buried. E) The do'gs bone was buried.
10. Rewrite showing possession: the homework belonging to the whole class (more than one pupil).
11. Add commas to this list: 'The recipe needs flour sugar butter and eggs.'
12. Which word correctly shows that something belongs to more than one teacher? A) teachers B) teacher's C) teachers' D) teachers's E) teacher,s
13. Write a sentence using the contraction 'they're' correctly.
14. Explain the difference in meaning between 'the boy's bag' and 'the boys' bag'.

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15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use a comma before a name in direct address? A) Come here, Priya. B) Come, here Priya. C) Thank you Sam for your help. D) Thank you, Sam, for your help. E) Hello Dad how are you?

Green — Building Fluency (15 questions)

1. Punctuate correctly: 'Although it was cold Maya refused to wear a coat.'

2. Explain why a comma is needed after 'Although it was cold' in the sentence above.

3. Which sentence uses a comma correctly after a fronted adverbial? A) Later that evening the storm arrived. B) Later, that evening the storm arrived. C) Later that evening, the storm arrived. D) Later that, evening the storm arrived. E) Later that evening the storm, arrived.

4. Write the correct possessive for: the collars belonging to several cats.

5. Explain why 'the children's playground' uses an apostrophe before the s even though 'children' already looks plural.

6. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences use commas correctly to mark a clause in the middle of a sentence? A) My uncle, who lives in Spain, is visiting. B) My uncle who, lives in Spain is visiting. C) The house, that we saw yesterday, was for sale. D) The cake which Grandma baked, was delicious. E) The dog, a small terrier, barked all night.

7. Correct this sentence: 'Its been raining since this morning so bring an umbrella.'

8. Which sentence correctly punctuates a list that includes a describing phrase? A) We saw lions, tigers, and bears, at the zoo. B) We saw lions, tigers and, bears at the zoo. C) We saw lions, tigers and bears at the zoo. D) We saw, lions tigers and bears at the zoo. E) We saw lions tigers, and bears, at the zoo.

9. Write the possessive form for: the opinions belonging to James (one person).

10. Explain the difference between 'your' and 'you're', giving one correct example sentence for each.

11. Punctuate this sentence correctly: 'Yes Miss Patel I have finished my essay.'

12. Which sentence correctly uses an apostrophe to show joint possession? A) Jack and Jills' house was large. B) Jack's and Jill's house was large. C) Jack and Jill's house was large. D) Jacks and Jills house was large. E) Jack and Jill house's was large.

13. Rewrite this list of adjectives with correct commas: 'It was a long cold tiring journey.'

14. Explain why 'the women's changing room' is correct but 'the women's' changing room' (with an extra apostrophe after the s) would be wrong.

15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these are correctly punctuated sentences with a comma before a coordinating conjunction joining two main clauses? A) The rain stopped, and the sun came out. B) The rain stopped and, the sun came out. C) I wanted to stay but I had to leave. D) I wanted to stay, but I had to leave. E) The match ended, the fans cheered.

Red — Challenge (15 questions)

1. Correct and explain every comma error in: 'The chef who trained in Paris cooked a rich delicious, meal for the critics who were very impressed.'

2. Explain the difference between 'the dog's bone', 'the dogs' bone' and 'the dogs bone', and say which is NOT standard English.

3. Which sentence correctly uses a comma to separate a non-essential (extra) clause from essential information? A) The novel that won the prize, is on the shelf. B) The novel, that won the prize is on the shelf. C) The novel, which won the prize, is on the shelf. D) The novel which, won the prize is on the shelf. E) The novel which won the prize is, on the shelf.

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4. Rewrite correctly, fixing both a missing comma and a misused apostrophe: 'Its a shame that the twin's bikes were stolen last night.'

5. Select ALL that apply. Which of the following show CORRECT use of an apostrophe for possession? A) the children's toys B) the mens' coats C) the boss's office D) the ladies' room E) James' car (also accept James's car)

6. Explain when 'it's' should be used instead of 'its', giving two example sentences — one for each meaning of 'it's'.

7. Which sentence is correctly punctuated with commas around a parenthetical (interrupting) phrase? A) My sister, a talented violinist will perform tonight. B) My sister a talented violinist, will perform tonight. C) My sister, a talented violinist, will perform tonight. D) My sister a talented, violinist will perform tonight. E) My, sister a talented violinist will perform tonight.

8. Explain why 'the class's trophy' is correct for one class, but 'the classes' trophy' would mean something different. Give the meaning of each.

9. Correct this sentence, which contains two comma errors and one apostrophe error: 'My grandparents who live in Leeds are visiting us and their bringing the dogs toys.'

10. Which sentence correctly punctuates direct speech with a comma before the reporting clause? A) 'I'm leaving now' said Tom. B) 'I'm leaving now,' said Tom. C) 'I'm leaving now', said Tom. D) 'I'm leaving now.' said Tom. E) 'I'm leaving, now' said Tom.

11. Explain the rule for forming the possessive of a singular noun that already ends in s (e.g. James, the boss), and give one correctly punctuated example.

12. Select ALL that apply. Which sentences correctly use a comma to mark off a fronted adverbial or subordinate clause? A) Despite the heavy rain the match continued. B) Despite the heavy rain, the match continued. C) Having finished her homework, she went outside. D) Having finished her homework she went outside. E) Before the sun rose, the fishermen set off.

13. Write one sentence containing a list of three adjectives, correctly comma-separated, AND one possessive apostrophe used correctly, then underline both features.

14. Explain why 'the teachers' staffroom' and 'the teacher's staffroom' have different meanings, giving the meaning of each.

15. Correct this passage, which has three punctuation errors (two commas, one apostrophe): 'Although the weather was poor the teams captain decided the match should continue, because the crowd who had travelled far wanted to see it.'

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